SARA AHARON

Territorial Planning Student

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✦ PROFILE

Territorial Planning student specializing in GIS-based spatial analysis and remote sensing applications. Experienced in utilizing QGIS, Google Earth Engine, Sentinel-2, Landsat imagery, and VIIRS nighttime lights data to monitor urban expansion, green infrastructure dynamics, and coastal geomorphology. Authored award-winning national research and presented at international Earth Observation workshops.

✦ EDUCATION & ACADEMIC HONORS

B.Sc. in Territorial Planning • Alexandru Ioan Cuza University of Iași Oct 2024 – Present
Faculty of Geography and Geology | Iași, Romania

- **Academic Merit Scholarship Recipient** (2024–2025 & 2025–2026)
- **1st Prize – Top Student:** Ranked 1st overall in Territorial Planning specialization (Year 1 & Year 2)

Just & Resilient Communities – Field Research Program 16 - 23 May 2026
Van Hall Larenstein Univ. (NL), ADR Nord-Est, & UAIC | Piatra Neamț, Romania
Field research on community livelihoods to develop actionable policy recommendations for local authorities.

Academia RATIO XVI – Summer School Aug 2026 – Sept 2026
Babeș-Bolyai University, Faculty of Economics and Business Administration | Cluj-Napoca, Romania

Erasmus+ BIP – Safe Mountain Explorer 15 - 19 Jun 2026
Wrocław University of Health and Sport Sciences | Wrocław, Poland

European Economic Studies Oct 2013 – Jun 2014
Romanian-American University | Bucharest, Romania

✦ RESEARCH PROJECTS & PUBLICATIONS

Cloud-Based Monitoring of 20 Years of Shoreline Change on Ko Phi Phi Don, Thailand Jun 2026 – Oct 2026

- **Publication:** Aharon, S. (2026). Cloud-Based Monitoring of Twenty Years of Shoreline Change on Ko Phi Phi Don, Thailand, Using Google Earth Engine and Multi-Temporal Satellite Imagery. *Proc. 6th Int. Electronic Conf. on Remote Sensing (ECRS 2026)*, MDPI, Basel, Switzerland.
- Executed a 20-year multi-temporal satellite analysis (2004–2024) utilizing Landsat and Sentinel-2 imagery in Google Earth Engine, QGIS, and ArcGIS. Integrated GIS transect analysis to quantify erosion/accretion patterns and evaluate tourism pressure impacts.

Earth Observation for Disaster Risk Management 16 Sept 2026

- **Italian Space Agency (ASI) & CEOS WGD International Workshop** | Rome, Italy
- Developed and presented a scientific research poster on satellite Earth Observation techniques applied to disaster risk assessment and environmental monitoring.

Spatio-Temporal Dynamics of Urban Green Infrastructure – Focșani Municipality (1990–2025) 20 Nov 2025

- **Award: 2nd Prize** at the *"Mihai David" National Student Symposium (15th Ed., UAIC Iași)*.
- Formulated a 35-year geospatial analysis of urban expansion and green space loss, establishing an inverse relationship between built-up density and urban vegetation cover for sustainable urban planning policy.

✦ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Operations Manager • **Dead Freddies LLC** June 2015 – Jan 2024
Ocean City, Maryland, United States

- Directed daily operations and led a multinational team in a high-volume hospitality venue.
- Developed high-level leadership, crisis management, cross-cultural communication, and operational problem-solving capabilities.

✦ CONFERENCES, SYMPOSIA & WORKSHOPS

International Geographic Seminar "Dimitrie Cantemir" (46th Ed.) — Oral Presentation, UAIC Iași (Oct 2026)

The 6th International Electronic Conference on Remote Sensing (ECRS 2026) — Oral Presentation, MDPI (Oct 2026)

ASI-CEOS WGD Workshop on Earth Observation for Disaster Risk Management — Scientific Poster Presentation, Italian Space Agency (ASI), Rome, Italy (Sept 2026)

JUST4MPA Hands-on Conference: Blue Justice and Social Equity for Marine Protected Areas — Participant, University of Bucharest (Jun 2026)

National Conference "George Vâlsan" — Oral Presentation, Babeș-Bolyai University, Cluj-Napoca (May 2026)

Annual Scientific Communications Session (31st Ed.) — Oral Presentation, University of Craiova (May 2026)

Hyperspectral Remote Sensing Workshop — Participant, Organized by ASI (Italy), DLR (Germany), ROSA (Romania) & POLITEHNICA Bucharest (Apr 2026)

BACKUP GISRS International Symposium (Spring Ed., 32nd Ed.) — Oral Presentation, UAIC Iași (Mar 2026)

National Symposium of Student Geographers (32nd Ed.) — Oral Presentation, CCMESI & University of Bucharest (Mar 2026)

geo-spatial.org Seminars (45th Ed.) — Oral Presentation, Chișinău, Republic of Moldova (Mar 2026)

"Mihai David" National Student Symposium (15th Ed.) — Oral Presentation & 2nd Place Winner, UAIC Iași (Nov 2025)

TELLURIA International Youth Conference for Earth Sciences & Humanities (2nd Ed.) — Oral Presentation, UAIC Iași (Nov 2025)

Climate Change Summit 2025 — Participant, Palace of Parliament, Bucharest (Oct 2025)

✦ CIVIC ENGAGEMENT & LEADERSHIP

Student Policy Delegate • **Forum of Romanian Students Worldwide** Sept 2025
Ministry of Labour, Family, Youth and Social Solidarity & Union of Romanian Students | Bucharest, Romania
Collaborated with student delegates from Romania and the diaspora to draft consensus-based youth policy recommendations for formal ministerial consideration.

Environmental Fieldwork & Documentary Contributor • **V.O.T.C.A. Project** Sept 2025
Ministry of Labour, Family, Youth and Social Solidarity & ETH Student League | Vatra Dornei, Suceava, Romania
Participated in mountain environmental field evaluations and documentary film production (*Vreau O Țară Ca Afară*, 2025) assessing ecological conditions and community impact.

Youth Mentor & Cultural Guide • **ARC Camps** Aug 2024
Department for Romanians Everywhere (Government of Romania) | Tulnici, Vrancea, Romania
Guided and mentored 50 youth from the Romanian diaspora in Ukraine and Moldova during a one-week cultural exchange program focused on heritage and identity reconnection.

✦ TECHNICAL SKILLS & LANGUAGES

GIS & Remote Sensing:	QGIS, ArcGIS, Google Earth Engine, Landsat, Sentinel-2, Copernicus, NDVI, NDWI, NDBI, LST, Aerial/UAV Imagery
Data & Development:	Python, SQL, VS Code, HTML, CSS, GitHub Pages, Geospatial Data Analysis
Soft Skills:	Research Analysis, Leadership, Teamwork
Language Proficiency:	**Romanian:** Native | **English:** C1 (Fluent) | **Spanish:** Intermediate | **German:** Beginner

✦ PROFESSIONAL CERTIFICATIONS

GIS, Remote Sensing & Cartography

- **ESRI:** GIS for Climate Action (Mar 2026)
- **ESRI:** Going Places with Spatial Analysis (Feb 2026)
- **ESRI:** GIS Basics (Feb 2026)
- **ESRI:** The ArcGIS Imagery MOOC: Foundations and Frontiers (Nov 2025)
- **ESRI:** Cartography (Oct 2025)
- **ESRI:** Make an Impact with Modern Geo Apps (May 2025)
- **NASA:** Fundamentals of Remote Sensing (Nov 2025)

Climate, Nature & Conservation

- **IUCN Academy:** Synthetic Biology in Relation to Nature Conservation (Aug 2026)
- **IUCN Academy:** Introduction to Mapping Biodiversity Priorities (Aug 2026)
- **IUCN Academy:** Introduction to Finance for Nature (Aug 2026)
- **IUCN Academy:** Introduction to Conservation and Agriculture (Aug 2026)
- **IUCN Academy:** Introduction to Cities and Nature (Aug 2026)
- **IUCN Academy:** Introduction to Conservation and Climate Change (Aug 2026)
- **IUCN Academy:** United for Nature and Society (Aug 2026)
- **IUCN Academy:** Nature's Crown Jewels: An Introduction to Nature World Heritage (Aug 2026)
- **RECOFTC:** Community Forestry 101 (Jul 2026)
- **HP Foundation:** Circular Economy (May 2025)

Data, AI & Open Science

- **Esri on AWS:** The Rise of GeoAI (Feb 2026)
- **NASA:** NASA Open Science 101 (Feb 2026)
- **NASA:** NASA Open Science Essentials (Feb 2026)
- **AWS:** Fundamentals of Machine Learning and Artificial Intelligence (Jan 2026)
- **Google Cloud Training:** Intro to Generative AI (Jan 2026)
- **HP Foundation:** Data Science & Analytics (May 2025)

Aviation & Technical Qualifications

- **EASA:** A1/A3 Open Sub Category Drone Pilot License (Valid to Dec 2030)
- **ICDL / ECDL Romania:** IT Skills Certification (Jan 2010)